

Write Your Own conio.h for GNU/Linux

Here's a close look at the technique and code for console handling in Standard (i.e., ISO/ANSI) C/C++. In the latter part of the article readers are encouraged to write their own code for the `clrscr`, `getch`, `textcolor`, and `textbackground` functions.

```
#include <stdio.h>
#include "conio.h"
int main()
{
    textbackground(BLUE);
    textcolor(WHITE);
    clrscr();
    printf("Hello, World!\n");
    getch();

    return 0;
}
```



Before taking up the matter at hand, it would be useful to note the key differences between Turbo C/C++ and Standard C/C++:

1. Turbo C and Turbo C++ are IDEs developed by Borland, which use their C/C++ implementations and compilers, while Standard C and C++ are supported by all famous compilers such as GCC.
2. Turbo C/C++ are only for DOS (and Windows), while Standard C/C++ is portable.
3. Turbo C++ was discontinued in 2006, while Standard C/C++ will be sustained for ever (even though the standards might be updated).
4. Turbo C and C++ are proprietary software, while Standard C and C++ are just languages that are supported by Free (Libre) compilers.

Hence it is recommended that you use Standard C/C++ if you're doing anything serious. It may be noted here that:

1. Standard C/C++, ANSI C/C++ and ISO C/C++ are the same.
2. For the sake of convenience, I will use only *stdio.h* and *printf* from this point onwards. You may replace it with *iostream* and *cout* if you are using C++.
3. If you are new to Standard C/C++, use *iostream* instead

of *iostream.h* and add a line using *namespace std*; after adding all header files. There will be no other notable differences. C, Turbo and Standard are almost the same (at least at the basic levels).

Console formatting with Turbo C

Consider a simple program to make the background colour of the console blue, and to print the message 'Hello, World!' in white.

You may use the following code in Turbo C.

Code 1:

```
#include <stdio.h>
#include <conio.h>
void main()
{
    clrscr(); // Clear the console
    textbackground(BLUE);
    textcolor(WHITE);
    printf("Hello, World!\n");
    return;
}
```